

BØRGE BRENDE
President, World Economic Forum

INDIA HAS MADE G3 A FACT

Over the years, on the global stage, Borge Brende, the president of the World Economic Forum, has established himself as one of the most enthusiastic advocates of the India story. At the India Today Conclave, Brende reiterated his strong belief in the growth trajectory of the Indian economy. He also highlighted the potential for economic expansion in emerging markets and emphasised the importance of investing in new-age technologies. He acknowledged that the India story is not just about potential and optimism; he confidently stated that "it is India's century". Brende justified his optimism by pointing out that India is the fastest-growing among the large economies and expressed hope that it would continue to grow at around 8 per cent.

Brende is bullish about India's potential for exponential growth over the next 25 years, with a caveat—the pace of reforms must continue to accelerate for this to happen. He stressed that India's growth trajectory is not only beneficial for itself but also for other countries, noting that India alone contributed a significant 15 per cent to global growth last year. His argument revolved around the idea that this demand was creating opportunities for the rest of the world as well. Brende hopes that India will reach the $10 trillion economy mark in the next decade and stressed the term 'G3', which he claims to have coined and refers to an elite club comprising the US, China and India. "This notion of G3 is now becoming a fact," he said.

Brende argued that India, alongside China, was assuming a leadership role among emerging economies. Currently, these economies contribute around 50 per cent of global growth, with projections indicating a rise to 60 per cent from 2040 onwards. He emphasised the need for India to get rid of its old problem of red tape, enhance existing infrastructure investments and prioritise education. Brende underlined India's high level of digital literacy and its potential to become a major manufacturing hub, noting that many companies were already establishing themselves here. However, he also suggested that India should look at the tariffs to complement it. ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **India is contributing 15 per cent to the global growth. This is positioning India among the real leaders in the emerging economies. The contribution of the emerging economies will expand in the next two decades**
- **India must fully embrace new technologies, like AI, proactively. Several rich countries post-World War II are now lower middle-income countries and some are the richest countries in the world**

Photographs by **BANDEEP SINGH**

IT IS INDIA'S CENTURY. INDIA IS THE FASTEST GROWING AMONG THE LARGE ECONOMIES IN THE WORLD. WE FORESEE THAT INDIA WILL BE GROWING FOR THE NEXT 25 YEARS, PROVIDED, OF COURSE, THAT THE REFORMS ARE CONTINUING

A lot of things, [including] the geopolitics, are working in India's favour. Secondly, you have so much of a youth [population]...on top of it, you also have fiscal prudence

INDIA IS UNIQUELY POSITIONED TO GAIN FROM THESE NEW TECHNOLOGIES [AI] BECAUSE YOU HAVE DIGITALLY LITERATE, HARDWORKING PEOPLE; YOU ALSO HAVE THE KEY CRITICAL MASS